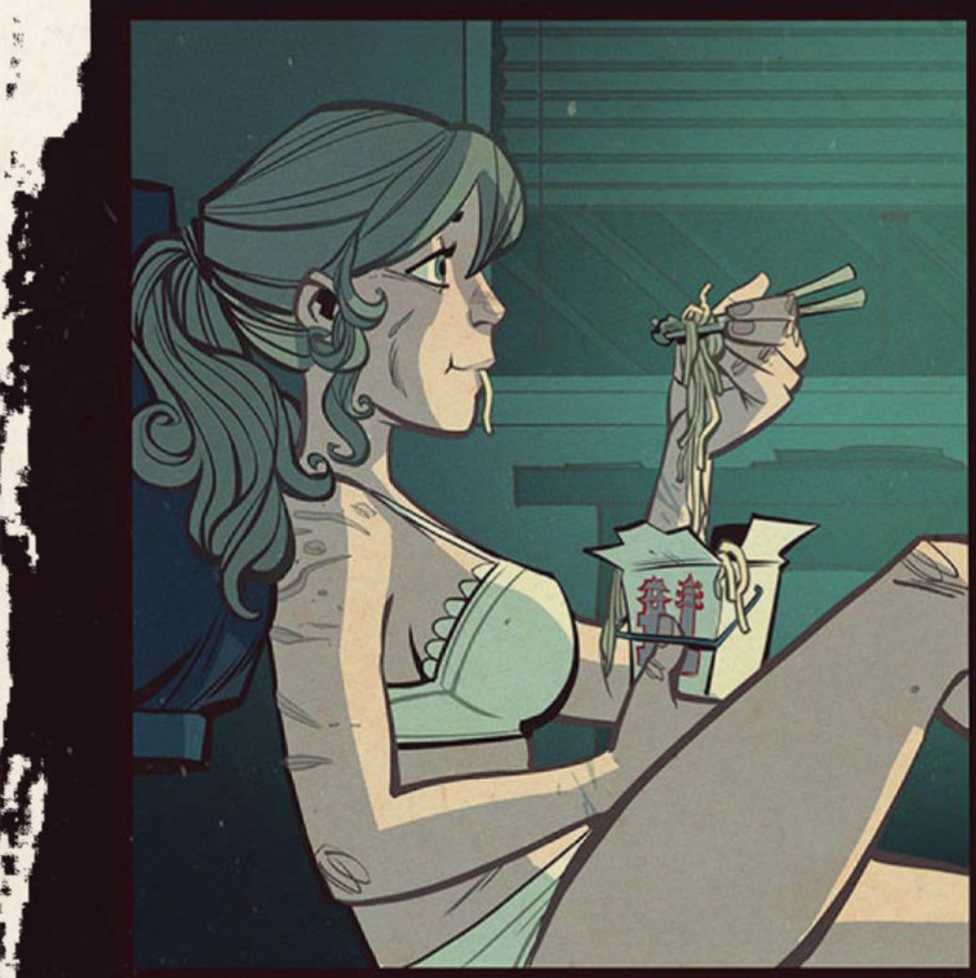
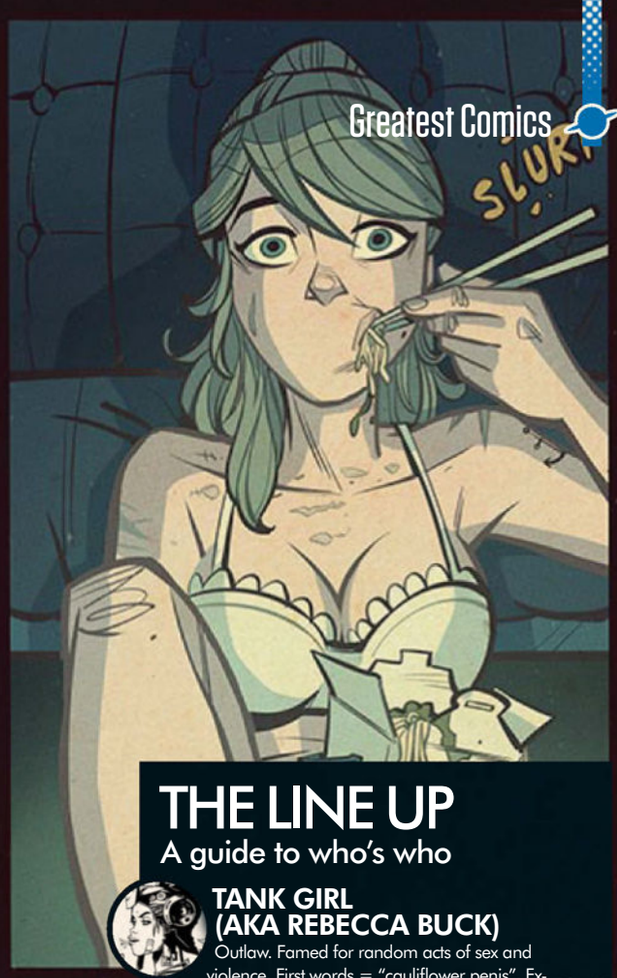




THE LINE UP

A guide to who's who

TANK GIRL (AKA REBECCA BUCK)
Outlaw. Famed for random acts of sex and violence. First words = "cauliflower penis". Ex-bounty hunter. Hair and clothing can and will change at random.



TANK
Has a girl in.



BOOGA
Mutated kangaroo and Tank Girl's besotted boyfriend. Huge fan of Dame Edna, and previously a successful toy designer. Will do anything Tank Girls tells him. *Anything*.



CAMP KOALA
A gay koala-shaped stuffed toy, described as the "Jeremy Thorpe of comics". Dies tragically playing hand-grenade baseball, but returns as a guardian angel. The only character TG admits to loving. Often sports a pierced ear and a foul mouth.



SQUEAKY TOY RAT
Well, the name says it all really.



MR PRECOCIOUS
A tiny mutant animal that has little luck, but some excellent sunglasses. Capable of driving a tank, apparently.



STEVIE
An Aborigine neighbour with wild blonde hair and many helpful family connections. Always up for a larf.



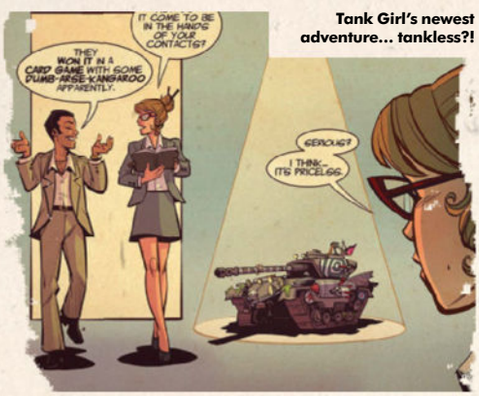
SUB GIRL
Submarine pilot and childhood friend of Tank Girl. Described as "like a beautiful flower floating in the loo." Always up for a heist.



JET GIRL
Jet pilot and fellow BFF of Tank Girl – an exceptional mechanic, but extremely boring to talk to. Self-confessed fan of Rod Stewart.



BOAT GIRL
There may be a pattern here…



Tank Girl's newest adventure... tankless?!

and celebrity alike. Out steps Tank Girl, all shaven head and a demented expression plastered on her face – a female Spider Jerusalem with goggles and plasters, grinning at the one surviving kangaroo, the gang leader, as he runs for his life.

"Geez, how come I can hear everything he's saying?" she turns to the reader as he legs it over the horizon huffing and swearing. "Must be something to do with comics and all that crap!"

Catching the 'roo, one Rocky Deadhead, after the two climb a mountain and collapse in exhausted and hysterical laughter, the two are soon snogging. After a quick shag, Deadhead grins at his good fortune before Tank Girl blows his brains away with her gun. She is a bounty hunter after all. That unexpected ending and meta commentary is perhaps why Tank Girl has outlasted so many of her alternative comix peers.

"She's a strong, highly recognisable female character – there aren't many to choose from," reckons Martin. "If there were more, Tank Girl would probably have drowned in a sea of ripped tights, spiky hair, target t-shirts, and baseball bats years ago."

"She's a true badass!" Parson grins. "She's confident, hilarious, sexy, raunchy, violent... everything you could want from a comic, right?"

"Lots of people think she's ace," agrees Johnson-Cadwell. "It may be from the comics they read, it might be for the film, but she is a memorable character. And her adventures, as crazy as they may be, are rooted in the day to day. There's no canon to get crushed under or excluded from; it's her character that people can quickly recognise and enjoy... maybe admire?"

In her second strip, Tank Girl was given the top-priority mission of delivering colostomy bags to the 92-year-old President Paul Hogan of Australia, but when she encounters a tank-jacker en route the ensuing literal shitstorm sees her cast as an outlaw forever more.

Tank Girl didn't feature much in the way of conventional plot or committed narrative as it held firmly to the slippery spirit of anarchy, and her creators perhaps didn't envision her turning into the pop culture and political icon she almost immediately became.

Protests against Thatcher's Clause 28, the homophobic amendment that prevented local authorities from 'promoting' homosexuality, used Tank Girl as their literal poster girl. Appearing on t-shirts and underpants alike, Tank Girl was the face of resistance against the hated clause – which was eventually repealed across the UK in 2003.

"Apart from the Clause 28 thing, we've never attached Tank Girl to anything specific," states Martin, "it's too defining to the character to put her in that position, plus I don't think she would do anyone's cause any favours."

Lauded by both the Riot Grrrl movement and prominent LGBT groups, *Deadline*'s publisher Tom Astor recalled for Wired in 1994 that "in London, there are even weekly lesbian gatherings called *Tank Girl* nights". Understandably then, Tank Girl is frequently